

QUILLTONY TECHNOLOGIES

Comprehensive Global Employee Handbook

Operational Governance, Workforce Policies, Benefits Architecture, and Legal Compliance Frameworks

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1. Administrative Governance & Employment Classifications

1.1 Executive Intent & Scope

Quilltony Technologies is committed to maintaining transparent, equitable, and legally compliant operational standards across all operating entities. This Handbook codifies core employment parameters, operational paradigms, and organizational expectations for all personnel. Unless explicitly modified by a localized entity addendum in Section 12, these policies apply universally across all global operating divisions.

1.2 FLSA Exempt vs. Non-Exempt Classifications

In strict compliance with the United States Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and corresponding international labor codes, Quilltony Technologies categorizes every position based on duties, autonomy, and compensation thresholds:

- **Exempt Personnel:** Positions primarily professional, executive, or administrative in scope. Exempt employees are paid a fixed salary and are not eligible for statutory overtime premium pay.
- **Non-Exempt Personnel:** Positions subject to statutory minimum wage and overtime mandates. Non-exempt employees must record all working hours accurately and receive 1.5x base hourly pay for hours worked exceeding 40 in a single workweek.

Classification Tier	FLSA Status	Standard Workweek	Overtime Authorization Requirement
Full-Time Regular (FTE 1.0)	Exempt	40 Hours Nominal	N/A (Salaried Output Model)
Full-Time Hourly (FTE 1.0)	Non-Exempt	40 Hours Strictly Recorded	Prior Written Approval from Direct Manager
Part-Time Regular (FTE < 0.8)	Non-Exempt	< 30 Hours Recorded	Mandatory Executive Approval Over 30 Hours

2. Code of Business Conduct & Whistleblower Protections

Quilltony Technologies enforces a zero-tolerance mandate regarding corrupt, illegal, or unethical business practices. Personnel are strictly required to avoid conflicts of interest, safeguard company assets, and comply with all anti-bribery statutes (including the US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act and UK Bribery Act). Reports of misconduct can be submitted anonymously through the Quilltony Governance Portal at ethics.quilltony.com. Retaliation against any employee reporting a violation in good faith is strictly prohibited and subject to immediate termination.

3. Equal Opportunity, Anti-Harassment, & Workplace Civility

Quilltony Technologies provides equal employment opportunities to all individuals regardless of race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, genetics, sexual orientation, or gender identity. Sexual harassment, verbal abuse, and bullying are rigorously enforced against. Escalation follows a three-step protocol:

1. Direct informal resolution if safe and appropriate;
2. Formal escalation to People Operations via peopleops@quilltony.com ;
3. External independent audit if executive leadership is implicated.

4. Asynchronous Communication & Remote Operations

As a remote-first organization, Quilltony Technologies prioritizes asynchronous collaboration over real-time meetings. Core collaboration windows are restricted to 10:00 AM to 2:00 PM EST. All operational decisions, architectural choices, and strategy updates must be recorded in internal wiki repositories rather than isolated private messaging channels.

5. Time Off, Absence, & Accrual Policies

Paid Time Off (PTO) at Quilltonty Technologies accrues per semi-monthly pay period based on completed length of continuous service. Accrual transitions take effect on the first day of the pay period following the milestone anniversary.

Tenure Milestone	FLSA Status	Accrual Rate / Pay Period	Max Annual Accrual	Standard Carryover Cap*	CA / MT Override Cap**
0 to 24 Months	Non-Exempt	3.693 Hours	96 Hours	40 Hours	144 Hours
0 to 24 Months	Exempt	4.615 Hours	120 Hours	40 Hours	180 Hours
25 to 60 Months	Non-Exempt	5.230 Hours	136 Hours	56 Hours	204 Hours
25 to 60 Months	Exempt	6.153 Hours	160 Hours	56 Hours	240 Hours
61+ Months	All Roles	7.692 Hours	200 Hours	80 Hours	300 Hours

*Standard carryover caps enforce a strict 'use-it-or-lose-it' policy on December 31st for standard jurisdictions.

**California, Montana, and Illinois jurisdictions prohibit vacation forfeiture by law; see Section 12 for explicit statutory overrides.

6. Parental Leave & Family Caregiving Top-Up Coordination

Quilltonty Technologies provides up to 16 continuous weeks of fully paid Parental Leave to eligible regular employees following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. Company top-up pay coordinates with state statutory benefits (such as California PFL or New York PFL) to ensure the employee receives 100% of their base salary during the approved 16-week window.

7. Group Health, Welfare, & Retirement Benefits

All regular full-time employees working 30+ hours per week are eligible for medical, dental, and vision coverage effective the first day of the calendar month following employment commencement. Quilltonty Technologies sponsors a 401(k) retirement plan featuring a 100% dollar-for-dollar employer match up to 4% of eligible annual earnings, fully vested immediately upon contribution.

8. Professional Development & Growth Stipends

Employees are allocated an annual Professional Growth Stipend up to \$3,500 per fiscal year. Expense approvals require prior manager authorization and must directly relate to the employee's current professional domain or defined career ladder trajectory at Quilltonty Technologies.

9. Travel, Hospitality, & Business Expense Governance

Reimbursable business travel requires advance approval. Per diem lodging and meal caps are fixed by location tier (Tier 1 Metro: \$350/night lodging, \$85/day meals; Tier 2/3: \$220/night lodging, \$65/day meals). Alcohol is non-reimbursable except during formal corporate events approved by a Vice President.

10. IT Security, Asset Management, & Acceptable Use

All corporate laptops must utilize FileVault/BitLocker full-disk encryption and maintain continuous connections to Quilltonty MDM solutions. Passwords must adhere to a 16-character minimum requirement. Personal storage devices are strictly blocked on enterprise machines.

11. Intellectual Property & Open Source Contributions

DRAFT — PENDING BOARD APPROVAL & LEGAL REVIEW (NOT YET EFFECTIVE)

The policies set forth in Section 11.2 below represent proposed amendments regarding generative AI asset usage and personal side projects. This section **MUST NOT** be cited as binding corporate policy for active legal queries.

11.1 General IP Assignment (Active Policy)

All inventions, software code, processes, and documentation authored by employees within the scope of their employment or utilizing Quilltonty Technologies resources are the exclusive intellectual property of Quilltonty Technologies.

11.2 Proposed Commercialization Policy (DRAFT - Pending Review)

Proposed Clause: Employees may retain personal ownership of side open-source projects provided zero corporate hardware, time, or infrastructure was utilized, and the project does not directly compete with Quilltonty Technologies core SaaS offerings.

12. Jurisdictional Addenda & Statutory Overrides

Where local, state, or national laws conflict with general baseline policies established in Sections 1 through 10 of this Handbook, statutory mandates take precedence. The following entity addenda explicitly override baseline parameters:

12.1 California Statutory Addendum

- **PTO Non-Forfeiture Override:** Notwithstanding Section 5.1, accrued PTO for California-based personnel never expires and cannot be forfeited under any "use-it-or-lose-it" scheme. Accrual pauses only if total accrued balance hits the maximum cap (1.5x annual rate). Unused PTO must be paid out in full upon separation at final rate of pay.
- **Mandatory Rest Breaks:** Non-exempt California employees receive a net 10-minute paid rest break for every 4 hours worked.

12.2 United Kingdom Entity Addendum

- **Statutory Leave Alignment:** UK personnel receive 28 days of paid annual leave inclusive of public bank holidays, superseding standard baseline accrual tables in Section 5.